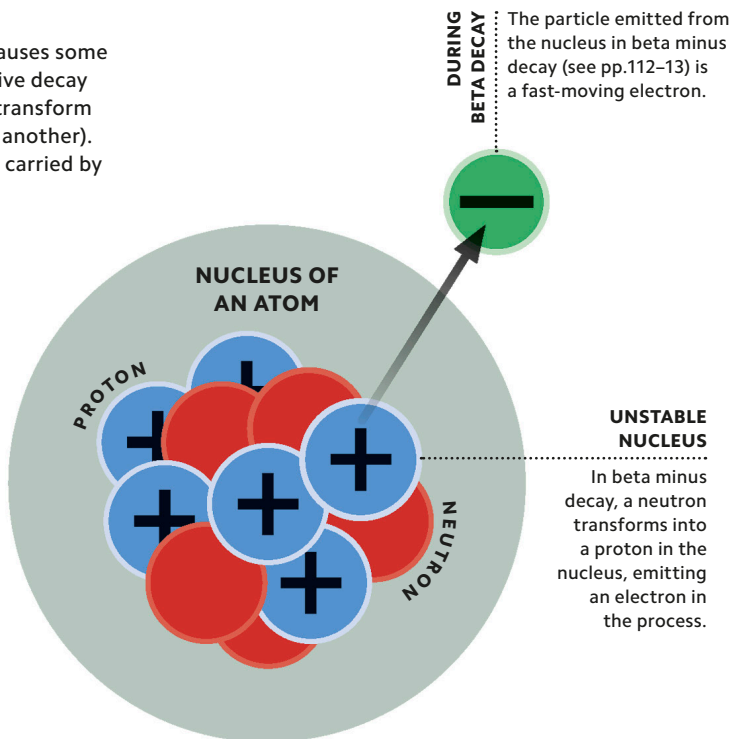


Weak force

The weak force causes some types of radioactive decay (where particles transform from one type to another). The weak force is carried by W and Z bosons.



THE FORCE OF DECAY

The weak force, as its name suggests, is less powerful than the strong and electromagnetic forces, and it operates over even smaller scales, only making itself felt at ranges below the diameter of a proton. However, weak interactions are hugely important as they can influence matter particles of all types (both quarks and leptons), and the weak force is the only one of the fundamental forces that can turn one type of particle into another type.